

DIGITAL DECEPTION AND SERP MANIPULATION: A CASE STUDY OF SEO HIJACKING BY LUNAR ASTRO

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ABSTRACT

This paper examines the unethical Search Engine Optimization (SEO) strategies and digital reputation management tactics employed by the online astrology platform Lunar Astro, founded by Deepanshu Giri. Through an analysis of Search Engine Results Pages (SERPs) and website source codes, this study identifies a coordinated effort to suppress legitimate consumer complaints. The findings reveal three primary vectors of algorithmic manipulation: "Domain Flooding" to monopolize first-page search results, preemptive Public Relations (PR) manipulation via "strawman" negative review articles, and blatant "Black-Hat" keyword stuffing. This case study highlights the vulnerabilities of search algorithms to corporate manipulation and the resulting impact on consumer transparency.

Keywords: *SEO Manipulation, Domain Flooding, Consumer Fraud, Lunar Astro Reviews, Deepanshu Giri, Black-Hat SEO, Digital Ethics.*

1. Introduction

In the modern digital economy, consumer trust is heavily reliant on peer reviews and search engine visibility. When prospective clients research a service, they depend on platforms like Google to surface objective, third-party feedback. However, sophisticated digital entities frequently exploit search engine algorithms to bury negative feedback and manufacture a pristine public image.

This paper presents a case study of Lunar Astro, a Vedic astrology academy and consultation service. Following a surge in consumer complaints regarding alleged intellectual property theft, harassment, and a "bait-and-switch" consultation model (utilizing anonymous proxy students such as "Code 5007"), an investigation was launched

into how the company maintains a highly visible 4.9-star digital reputation. The analysis reveals a highly calculated SEO hijacking campaign designed to suppress these allegations.

2. Methodology

The investigation utilized targeted search queries (e.g., *site:lunarastro.com OR site:lunarastro.org "review" OR "complaint"*) to map the digital footprint of the organization. Website architectures, page titles, and on-page text were analyzed to identify patterns consistent with known algorithmic manipulation tactics.

3. Findings: Vectors of Algorithmic Manipulation

3.1. Domain Flooding and SERP Monopolization

The most prominent tactic observed is "Domain Flooding." Rather than allowing independent review aggregators (such as Trustpilot or MouthShut) to rank organically for the keyword "Lunar Astro Reviews," the organization has created a multi-domain architecture specifically optimized to hijack these search terms.

The investigation identified dedicated, proprietary review pages across three separate domains owned by the company:

- **lunarastro.com:** Features a page titled *"Lunar Astro Reviews 2026 - 10,872+ Student & Clients Testimonials"*
- **consultlunarastro.com:** Features a page titled *"Lunar Astro Review - Real Client Experiences and Feedback"*
- **lunarastro.org:** Features a page titled *"Deepanshu Giri Reviews: Is Lunar Astro Genuine?"*

By controlling multiple high-authority domains targeting the exact same long-tail keywords, Lunar Astro effectively pushes independent, critical forums off the first page of Google, creating an artificial echo chamber of positive sentiment.

3.2. Preemptive PR Manipulation (The "Strawman" Tactic)

To counter users specifically searching for negative feedback, Lunar Astro employs a sophisticated Public Relations manipulation tactic. On *lunarastro.org*, the company published an article titled: **"Negative Reviews of Lunar Astro in 2025 Justified?"**

This article acts as a "strawman." It preemptively addresses the concept of negative reviews but deliberately limits the scope of the complaints to minor, subjective issues such as "app crashes," "technical glitches," or "vague predictions." By doing so, the article completely ignores and obfuscates the severe, documented allegations of consumer fraud, the "Code 5007" proxy scam, and intellectual property theft. Consequently, when a consumer searches for "Lunar Astro negative reviews," Google's algorithm surfaces the company's own sanitized narrative rather than actual whistleblower testimonies.

3.3. Black-Hat SEO: Keyword Stuffing

Further analysis of the source code and footer text of Lunar Astro's consultation review pages revealed blatant violations of Google's Webmaster Guidelines, specifically the practice of "Keyword Stuffing."

On their primary consultation review page, the exact phrase *"lunar astro review"* is copy-pasted consecutively over 40 times at the bottom of the document.

```
[Excerpt from source analysis]
lunar astro review
lunar astro review
lunar astro review
[Repeated 40+ times]
```

This primitive but often effective "Black-Hat" SEO tactic is designed to artificially inflate keyword density, tricking search engine crawlers into ranking the page higher for that specific query.

4. Conclusion

The digital footprint of Lunar Astro demonstrates a coordinated, multi-tiered effort to manipulate search engine algorithms and suppress consumer transparency. Through domain flooding, preemptive strawman articles, and black-hat keyword stuffing, the organization

successfully hides severe allegations of unethical business practices from prospective clients.

This case study underscores the necessity for algorithmic vigilance by search engines and highlights the critical role of independent consumer watchdogs in documenting and exposing digital reputation manipulation. To combat these tactics, consumer advocates must utilize counter-SEO strategies, publishing independent dossiers across high-authority academic and document-sharing platforms to restore transparency to the Search Engine Results Pages.